BRAIN 03

Cerebrolysin

Mixture of small peptides and amino acids taken from pig brain protein; not a single molecule



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Peptide mixture	Stroke, dementia, brain injury	Controlled human trials; mixed reviews	Not FDA approved

STUDIED FOR

Acute stroke	Recovery after stroke	Vascular dementia	Brain injury
HUMAN + ANIMAL	HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

Cochrane reviews (2019, 2023). Stroke: probably little or no difference in death; more non-fatal serious events. Dementia: very low-quality evidence.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Cerebrolysin ▶ Brain peptides ▶ Nerve protection ▶ Stroke recovery

- Some of its proteins **occur naturally** in the human brain
- **Nerve-protecting and nerve-growth** effects in preclinical (animal) stroke models
- **In people,** how it might act is not settled

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

CONTROLLED TRIALS
LEVEL 4 OF 5

- Many randomized trials, mostly stroke and dementia
- CASTA (1,070): no difference on main outcome
- Several trials funded by the maker

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Mechanism in people
- Half-life in people
- Death or dependence at follow-up
- Quality of life (not reported)

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established in people	Injection into muscle or vein, or IV infusion (Austrian leaflet)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	Not approved in the US; approved medicine in Austria
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Stroke and dementia scales; serious adverse events	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Not approved; not on compounding lists
BASG	Austria: approved (dementia, stroke, brain injury)
EMA	Not centrally authorised
WADA	Not listed

REFERENCES

1. Cochrane, Cerebrolysin for acute ischaemic stroke, Oct 2023
2. Stroke, CASTA trial of Cerebrolysin in acute stroke, Mar 2012
3. BASG (Austria), Cerebrolysin patient leaflet, Mar 2021

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